

1

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY - DAY (FLASHBACK)

1

An electric power chord. Empty halls of Black Willow Academy shown through a cheap camera lens. The title, "SUMMERWEEN BY STUPID BALL PIT CULT" shows in tacky horror font.

Two brightly colored, massive monster MASCOTS come into view, dancing through the corridors to heinous rock music.

They're pushed aside by a singing **MITCH VERLICE (16, brunette at the time)**, wearing BLACK CAP AND GOWN and playing ELECTRIC GUITAR. The monsters get back on their feet and dance behind him down the hall, in a triangular formation.

The school bell RINGS. Mitch, the monsters, and the music all halt. They look at it. A breath. Then they chuck papers into the sky.

2

EXT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY - DAY (FLASHBACK) (CONTINUOUS)

2

Mitch and the monsters escape through double doors, coming into glaring summer sun. They shield their eyes, vampiric. The monsters TEAR OFF Mitch's cap and gown, revealing a neon blue skeleton BODYSUIT.

Mitch slides down a staircase handle in chaos, still singing.

CARRIE (O.S.)

What are you doing?

The hand-held camera turns to reveal **CARRIE LANDRY (16)** and **LEXIE WILSON (15 at the time)**, standing at the opposite end of the school's otherwise barren courtyard. The hand-held camera returns to Mitch, revealing his mortified demeanor.

MITCH

(calling out)

What'd you say?

CARRIE

(calling out)

I asked what you're doing.

Lexie eyes the camera.

MITCH

Oh. Um.

Mitch gives the cameraman a look: cut the cameras, deadass. But the cameraman lingers, zooming into Mitch, before turning the camera towards himself: **CHAYTON WARCLOUD (16 at the time, Native American)**. The shot is all nose.

CHAYTON

This is Chayton Warcloud. That's a cut.

The music stops. Chayton turns off his camera, and the monsters take off their masks to reveal **VEDA WARCLOUD (16 at the time)** and a confused other **KID**.

MITCH

We're filming a music video.

CARRIE

What for? PBS Kids? How'd you even get permission?

Veda, fuming, locks eyes with Mitch.

CHAYTON

Ms. Marrero.

Chayton nudges Mitch on the shoulder, snickering like it's some inside joke. Carrie makes a face, somewhat challenged.

Mitch tries to laugh as she draws closer, hitting her vape. She eyes his nervous attraction towards her, grinning.

CARRIE

What's your name?

MITCH

Mit-

CARRIE

I know who the hell you are, Mitch. We've gone to school together since the sixth grade. I'm asking what your band's name is.

CHAYTON

Stupid Ball Pit Cult.

Carrie and Lexie exchange a look, stifling laughter.

CARRIE

You any good?

VEDA

Yeah. You wouldn't be into it.

MITCH

Why do you- why do you ask?

Carrie shrugs.

CARRIE

School's out. I'm throwing a party
at my parent's beach house. It's
got like a y2k feel. I feel like
you guys would be good for that.

Veda looks like she could throw up on Carrie.

VEDA

We'll pass-

Chayton flicks Veda.

CHAYTON

Dude!

MITCH

Guys!

He gestures for them to chill, turns back to Carrie.

MITCH (CONT'D)

You really want us to play at your
party?

Carrie exhales smoke, stepping closer.

CARRIE

(to Mitch)

Yeah. I want you to play for me.

CUT TO:

3

INT. HELL HOUSE, MASTER BEDROOM - DAY (PRESENT DAY)

3

Mitch stands lost while blood drips down the walls.

PARKER (O.S.)

FUCK! WHAT THE HELL! WHAT IS THIS?!
DUDE, WHAT IS THIS?! WHY ARE YOU
EVEN IN HERE, MAN?! THIS IS SICK!

PARKER HALL panics like a little girl, in bed with Lexie.
Lexie, who's still screaming.

The door barges open. Behind it stands **DR. FRANKLIN CROWE**,
followed by **JILL RAMIREZ**, **MIGUEL RAMIREZ**, **CHARLOTTE**, and
Carrie. Before anyone sees Parker and Lexie, they hide under
the covers.

Mitch locks eyes with a concerned Carrie as Dr. Crowe points
to him and an on-guard **DYLAN KLAYPOOL**.

CROWE
Ah and there they are! May I
present to you, people, our
culprits.

MITCH
What?!

Spoken simultaneously with:

CARRIE
Uh. No.

JILL
(to Carrie)
Well you couldn't have possibly
imagined this was real.

Dr. Crowe scoops up blood from his finger. He licks it off.

CROWE
Red chocolate syrup!

Everyone LAUGHS. Mitch tries it himself and looks at Dylan.
It's true.

DYLAN
I don't see how that's possible.

Dr. Crowe points to a pipe along the ceiling.

CROWE
Remote controlled pipe. Very
creative. You two did it, no? Get
back at mommy.

DYLAN
No.

MITCH
We didn't. Dr. Ramirez, I wouldn't.
I-

CROWE
Et, et, et. And yet you did.

CARRIE
Dr. Crowe...

Everyone looks at Carrie.

CARRIE (CONT'D)

It's just... I don't think Mitch is smart enough to pull something like this off.

MITCH

It's true.

He looks at Carrie.

MITCH (CONT'D)

I'm a total idiot.

Carrie smiles, small. None of this is lost on Dylan.

CROWE

And your pockets, hm? Let me see.

Mitch reaches into his pockets, expecting nothing, only to pull out a REMOTE CONTROL. The crowd REACTS.

MITCH

I've never seen this before in my life. You have to believe me!

DYLAN

Mitch?

CROWE

And the little Jill's pockets?

Dylan reaches into her pockets: an empty bottle of red dye. What?! Miguel holds up the MEL-METER he found.

MIGUEL

They were ghost hunting.

CROWE

Ah yes. And ghosts... They feed on fear. Or so they say.

He laughs hysterically, the crowd following his lead.

JILL

And that everyone, is a flawless example of how we can let our amygdala get the best of us! I hope you enjoyed the little show. Yes! It is the season of gore and... whatnot. Now, let's get some snacks and resume, shall we?

Guests sigh, relieved. Carrie gives Mitch a meaningful look before leaving. Jill gives Dylan and Mitch a terrible, stern glare before closing the door.

MITCH

Damn it. Damn it. Damn it!

He kicks the bed. Parker and Lexie come out.

PARKER

PHEW! That's a relief.

Parker hops out of the bed. Mitch and Dylan shield their eyes in horror upon seeing his naked body, which is conveniently out of anyone else's line of vision.

MITCH

DUDE, COME ON! Dylan's right there.

Spoken simultaneously with:

DYLAN

Oh no. OH my gosh. Oh dear. No.
That's not...

PARKER

What? She your girl?

He raises both eyebrows at Mitch three times.

MITCH

No... but A girl. And-

PARKER

Bro! Speaking of girls, was that
Carrie out there? Fuuucckk. Close
one, man, am I right?

Parker raises his hand for a high five. Mitch PUNCHES him in the face.

MITCH

Happy Halloween, Motherfucker.

We hear a crowd CHEER.

4

TITLE CARD: EPISODE 4, REVENGE OF THE INVISIBLE BOYFRIEND!

This title card is different, crazier. It's Mitch's.

5

EXT. LIGHTHOUSE BEACH - SUNSET (FLASHBACK)

5

In silhouette before a setting sun, Mitch performs his heart out to the sound of muffled teenage cheers. He punches Veda's drums until he bleeds. It's so loud that it's almost mute.

MITCH (V.O.)

Mitch Verlice. Audio log 19. Today
I felt like talking about the time
I got possessed.

6

EXT. LIGHTHOUSE BEACH - NIGHT (FLASHBACK)

6

JOINT between his bloody knuckles, Mitch takes a hit. He sits with Veda and Chayton. Far off behind is golden BONFIRE light and glorious LAUGHTER.

MITCH (V.O.)

Like all great stories, it started
last Summer. In a small town on the
cusp of Salem, Massachusetts. A
town... called Black Willow.

Chayton CHUCKLES to himself.

VEDA

Don't.

CHAYTON

I'm just saying if I had to have a
last show with you guys, I'm glad
it-

They argue over one another, yelling simultaneously.

VEDA

I can't hear you! I can't hear you!
Lalalala.

CHAYTON

Do you even hear yourself right
now? What are you? Five? You're
literally such a freak!

Mitch taps the excess from his joint, staring off.

CHAYTON (O.S.) (CONT'D)

I'm just trying to say that if I go
to the reservation in the fall- No!
Don't do that. Will you shut up?
Yes because I really might go. I've
been telling you this.

Spoken simultaneously with:

VEDA (O.S.)
 I'm uncomfortable with your words!
 I feel deeply offended by your
 words! What do you even want? Am I
 supposed to lie and say I'll miss
 you? Boo hoo. Oh! I'm so sad!

A burnt marshmallow on the end of a long stick finds itself
 in front of Mitch's face.

CARRIE (O.S.)
 Eat it.

He smirks.

MITCH
 I'm not doing that.

Carrie sits, replacing his view. She eats the marshmallow
 herself, locking in on his eyes. Sucking her fingers dry.

MITCH (V.O.)
 I'd thought of Carrie like a queen
 ever since I saw her, you know. The
 kind that cuts off heads.

Mitch finally turns away once he's too turned on.

CARRIE
 I want a hit.

She takes the joint from Mitch's mouth and holds out her hand
 for a LIGHTER. He complies. The lighter says, "wink when you
 pass this back if you want to bang."

MITCH
 Oh that's not-

Carrie LAUGHS, takes a hit. She tosses him the lighter and
 WINKS.

Carrie then proceeds to take off her shirt, revealing a
 bikini underneath. She shakes out her hair and runs into the
 ocean with the rest of his joint. He's frozen.

Chayton, sly, pats Mitch on the shoulder.

CHAYTON
 You want it, huh?

MITCH
 What?

7

EXT. MARY'S BATH - DAY (PRESENT DAY)

7

DYLAN

Do you want it?

Dylan stands beside Mitch, holding out bandage wrap. Mitch is by Mary's Bath, washing his knuckles. Jill is at a distance, watching. He holds out his hand, allowing Dylan to wrap it.

MITCH

What's the verdict? Can we be friends or what?

Dylan shakes her head, almost looking at her mom. Mitch grounds into reality at the sight of her about to cry.

DYLAN

But I'm gonna do it anyway.

He smiles.

8

EXT. BLACK WILLOW COURTHOUSE, BENCH - DAY

8

A sign outside says "**Black Willow Courthouse est. 1693.**" Mitch sits on a bench outside, reading. He sees Jill's CAR pull up. Dylan emerges, handing a **HOMELESS MAN** some money. Mitch grins.

JILL

You couldn't bother to go in, I see.

Jill discovers a sign on the door: "**COURTHOUSE BACK IN SESSION AT 12PM.**" She could stomp a foot.

Jill sits beside Dylan, shielding her, but Dylan and Mitch exchange secret glances. Dylan opens her own copy of the same book Mitch is reading, trying to swallow a grin. He won't stop watching. She finally breaks away.

MITCH (V.O.)

Carrie's life loiters in me like a freaking rat in the wall.

Mitch's smile fades. Unseen by Mitch, Dylan looks back, catching his mood shift.

9

EXT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, GRAVEYARD - DUSK (FLASHBACK)

9

Mitch, brunette, walks through tombstones.

MITCH (V.O.)

It was early Summer still. Maybe June, let's say, and I had just finished the graveyard shift...

Carrie's CRYING stops Mitch in his tracks. She sees him, sucks everything in. He stands still, comfort-eyed.

MITCH (V.O.)

I knew about it, of course. But to tell you the truth, I couldn't even picture Carrie having an emotion.

CARRIE

...When you dig these, do you know who's going in them?

Mitch looks around.

MITCH

...Dorian Waters. A long life, just under a hundred. He was a black smith in World War 2, then started a shoe company for kids. Evelyn Josephine was her school's first female anthropologist. She studied the concubines in Istanbul. William, Helen, Henry. All born here and never left.

He looks at the grave Carrie came for.

MITCH (CONT'D)

And Lucas Landry. Eldest of three. 2025 homecoming king accepted to Pembroke on a softball scholarship.

CARRIE

...And committed suicide half way through his first semester. Do you usually leave out how it ends?

MITCH

Someone has to.

CARRIE

I can't understand how you don't become psychotic.

MITCH

Don't you believe in an afterlife?

CARRIE

Sounds entitled to me.

MITCH
More entitled than living without
faith?

A beat. The sound of a judge's GAVEL...

10

INT. BLACK WILLOW COURTHOUSE, COURTROOM - DAY

10

...POUNDING. Mitch startles, causing a tear to roll. He is sitting in the courtroom.

PASTOR (V.O.)
Welcome to community service at The
Sacred Mercy Church!

11

EXT. SACRED MERCY CHURCH - DAY

11

A huge BANNER saying "THE SACRED MERCY CHURCH FALL FESTIVAL," waves in the wind. Mitch and Dylan follow the PASTOR under it. They walk through the festival grounds, each carrying a TOTE BAG.

PASTOR
A brick through the window, huh?

DYLAN
Yes, Sir.

The priest giggles.

PASTOR
Worse things have been forgiven.

Dylan smiles. The pastor comes to a halt at a ticket tent.

PASTOR (CONT'D)
I think you'll find few punishments
more enjoyable than working at the
Fall Festival.

He looks at Mitch, who looks about ready to burst with excitement.

PASTOR (CONT'D)
Here is where you'll sell tickets.
One tent each. Oh and, uh, I put
the costumes in your employee bags.

Mitch and Dylan eye their bags. The pastor gives a thumbs up.

12

EXT. SACRED MERCY CHURCH, TICKET TENT AREA - NIGHT

12

Mitch sits in a ticket tent, wearing a clown costume. He looks across the entrance lane to Dylan, who's wearing the feminine version of the same costume in her own ticket tent.

She's hyper-focused on figuring out the register. A YOUNG CUSTOMER arrives. She welcomes her with gentleness. Mitch softens.

LEXIE (O.S.)
EXCUSE ME. HELLO. I'd like to give
you money, please.

He looks towards the noise: Lexie.

Her eyes shoot open when she notices it's Mitch. She BOLTS. Mitch CHASES after her, abandoning the tent.

13

EXT. SACRED MERCY CHURCH, FESTIVAL PATH - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Lexie RUNS through the festival, followed by Mitch.

LEXIE
You know chasing a girl in a clown
costume isn't exactly a good look,
right?

14

EXT. SACRED MERCY CHURCH, WATER GUN TENT - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Lexie runs into an Autumn themed water gun tent busy with CHILDREN.

LEXIE
Help! Someone help! He's chasing
me!

MITCH
She lies! She's a witch, I tell
you! We must GET HER!!!!

CHILDREN
GET THE WITCH! GET THE WITCH! GET
THE WITCH! GET THE WITCH!

The children spray Lexie, then chase her.

15

EXT. SACRED MERCY CHURCH, PUMPKIN PATCH - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Lexie runs through a small pumpkin patch, knocking over bundles of hay to block the children.

Mitch leaps over the hay, on her tail, as she books it into a photography tent.

16

INT. SACRED MERCY CHURCH, PHOTOGRAPHY TENT - NIGHT
(CONTINUOUS)

16

Lexie runs into the tent, coming face-to-face with a towering card stock scarecrow, a hole cut out at the face for photos. It startles her, but she exhales at the false scare.

Upon opening her eyes in the opposite direction, however, she sees a MASKED MONSTER. Lexie SCREAMS, cowering.

She finally peaks to see Dylan pull off the mask. Mitch stands on the other side of Lexie. She's trapped.

LEXIE

Ugh!

17

INT. SACRED MERCY CHURCH PHOTOGRAPHY TENT - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

Lexie sits on hay, pouting. Dylan and Mitch cross her, pacing in an interrogative style.

MITCH

Lexie Wilson. Fancy seeing you here. On a date with Parker, I presume? Very sweet of him to buy your tickets, wouldn't you say?

LEXIE

He's saving, for your information.

MITCH

Oh! What for? His actual girlfriend?

DYLAN

Your best friend...

Lexie eyes Dylan like a hawk. Dylan shrugs: it's the truth!

LEXIE

Oh OK like you're so innocent misses making eye contact with Carrie's ex across the table right in front of Carrie when Carrie was literally nice enough to invite you to lunch with us because you were actually eating in a freaking bathroom stall before that?

DYLAN
(with confusion)
...What?

LEXIE
Whatever! ...And YOU! What, you're
some kind of saint? You and Carrie
literally broke up BECAUSE you
cheated, and now you're gonna come
at me? As if this betrayal would
cause even a fraction of the
heartbreak yours did!

MITCH
(with care)
What? What do you mean by
heartbreak?

Lexie rolls her eyes.

DYLAN
OK. Can we focus?! Please. Thank
you. Lexie, we're not going to tell
Carrie about you and Parker...

Lexie looks at her with an inquiry of the catch.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
IF... you give us access to Hell
House.

Lexie looks between Dylan and Mitch. *That's it?*

18

EXT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, GRAVEYARD - NEW DAY

18

Veda is walking through the graveyard towards Mitch's house,
drumsticks in hand, when she spots Carrie eating cherries
near her brother's tombstone. They lock eyes.

VEDA
You're not actually glamorizing
your nonexistent grief as a means
to manipulate someone whose known
more of it than you could fathom
while simultaneously having zero
interest in him anyway?

Carrie gets up. She begins to walk away, but thinks again.

CARRIE
 I hope, with all my apathetic heart
 of which you so effortlessly
 understand, that one day... you get
 picked.

Carrie walks away. You can practically see the steam leaving
 Veda's nostrils.

19

INT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, GARAGE - DAY

19

While Mitch is setting up for band practice, Veda charges
 into the garage. She keeps to herself, setting up while all
 pissed off, until she looks up and STOPS in surprise.

SAWYER HALL turns around, looking totally different. Much
 cooler. Kinda hot.

SAWYER
 What do you think?

MITCH
 Good, huh?

VEDA
 Better.

20

INT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, GARAGE - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

20

Sawyer, in his updated rockstar look, SHREDS on electric
 guitar to an original HALLOWEEN SONG. They finish.

21

INT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, GARAGE - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

21

Sawyer chugs water, then looks at Mitch. Mitch takes out his
 earphones. *What's up?*

SAWYER
 How was that?

MITCH
 Good, good dude! It rocked.

SAWYER
 You think I'll be ready for Friday?

MITCH
 More than ready, Man! You'll be
 fantastic!

SAWYER
It's just... a big crowd.

MITCH
Just the school.

Sawyer looks at him: *uh...yeah!*

MITCH (CONT'D)
Sawyer. Sawyer, Sawyer, Sawyer.
Relax. It's just a high school
Halloween dance. And look at you,
Man, with this new look. You look
cool as hell. Everyone'll love it.

Sawyer nods.

MITCH (CONT'D)
You going with Dakota?

SAWYER
No. Dakota and I are just friends.

Mitch gives him a look.

SAWYER (CONT'D)
There are some benefits, but... Eh,
I don't know. She wants that, but I
don't. I want something stable.

MITCH
My guy. That's beautiful. What are
you into then? If you don't mind me
asking, of course.

Sawyer's about to say something, then shies away.

MITCH (CONT'D)
What?!

SAWYER
I just don't know how you're gonna
feel about it.

MITCH
What! I'll be fine. Come on, Man.
Tell me.

SAWYER
All right. It's just... I know you
said you guys aren't a thing and...
I don't know. Would you be cool
with me, like, asking out Dylan?

Mitch's smile fades.

MITCH (V.O.)
You don't have feelings for me now,
do you?

QUICK FLASHCUTS:

- 3.24 Dylan and Mitch, back when they were on that bench.

DYLAN
What... no.

The moment replays, quick. Sometimes closing in on her eyes,
sometimes on the curve of her mouth.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
What... no. What... no. What... no.

- 2.7 Dylan furrowing her brows at all his books.

- 3.14 How Dylan looked at him after thinking he was gone.

DYLAN (V.O.)
You're handsome.

- 3.51 Dylan's reaction to seeing him with Carrie replays.

MITCH (V.O.)
Look at you! You're obsessed!

DYLAN (V.O.)
That is not it at all actually.

- 1.48 Dylan running into Mitch's arms at Hell House.

MITCH (V.O.)
You'll have to resist me.

DYLAN
I think I can manage that.

Mitch leans on the front gates of Hell House, pensive. He's
smoking a joint.

MITCH (V.O.)
There's a psychic on the edge of
town. A gifted and eccentric lady.

23

EXT. WILLOW READER COTTAGE - DAY (FLASHBACK)

23

A **TRIO OF ELDERLY, HIPPIE MEN** set up ODD INSTRUMENTS in front of THE WILLOW READER MADAME ZUGASTI's cottage.

MITCH (V.O.)
But she once told me I'd end up
with an enemy. I've only got one.

Carrie, sinister, meets Mitch's eyes.

MITCH (V.O.)
The Devil.

CARRIE
Wait here.

She walks in, leaving Mitch alone with the men. They nod at him, he returns the gesture. Mitch sits on a curb, loitering.

The men play a fun tune and Mitch hums along, both parties progressively getting louder. Mitch starts to dance, building into a full on performance.

Carrie exits the psychic, elated. She puts a newly purchased TAROT DECK in her purse, then sees Mitch leading the band. She shakes her head in disbelief.

He calls her over. She doesn't bother with much hesitation. The two dance.

HIPPY MAN #1
GIVE HER A KISS!

HIPPY MAN #2
YEAH, KISS HER ALREADY!

Mitch shakes his head, respectful. Carrie kisses him. Mitch kisses her back. The men CHEER.

A wind blows and Mitch's nose picks up the scent it carries.

24

EXT. HELL HOUSE - DAY

24

Mitch's senses bring him back to reality.

MITCH
Dylan.

He turns around, revealing Dylan. She's wearing silly disguise GLASSES.

DYLAN

Undercover. I've got exactly forty
five minutes before my mom returns.

Mitch dangles the house keys. They walk towards Hell House.
Dylan stops, looking up at it. Mitch watches patiently as she
closes her eyes and takes a deep breath.

MITCH

You good?

Dylan nods, reserved, and continues forward.

DYLAN

Do you happen to have a plan?

MITCH

You smell like bergamot and
caramel.

Dylan gives him a look, he smiles.

MITCH (CONT'D)

Files. We're looking for files.
Bank stuff, report cards, birth
certificates... There's an office
on the second floor. It could help
us connect with the spirit when we
communicate. Or uncover the story.

Dylan nods, walking beside him in silence for a bit.

DYLAN

You smell like weed.

He LAUGHS.

25

INT. HELL HOUSE, OFFICE - DAY

25

Dylan and Mitch enter the office of Hell House, all loose
papers and dust. Like the working space of a madman.

DYLAN

How neat.

MITCH

I'll get the filing cabinet.

As Mitch heads for the filing cabinet, Dylan looks around.
She is fidgety and tense, not willing to touch anything.

DYLAN

Hey. Who do you suppose framed us?

Mitch looks at her, half laughing.

MITCH

It's obvious. The freaking guy who showed off by busting us.

DYLAN

OK, and when slash how exactly would a man his age apply piping along the high ceiling?

MITCH

Some assistant no doubt. Dude probably built his whole career by debunking mysteries he made up. Now LOOK FOR FILES. What are you? A scarecrow?

Dylan moseys to the bookshelf.

MITCH (CONT'D)

Not too sure if we have time for a little light reading, Dillstick.

Dylan hesitates before pulling out a book on the shelf. She opens it, revealing a hollowed out center with files inside.

MITCH (CONT'D)

You embarrass me sometimes.

26

EXT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, FRONT DOOR - DAY

26

ABIEZER MARRERO is sitting on his rocking chair by the front door when Miguel approaches from outside the window.

MIGUEL

Abiezer? Mind if I ask you a couple questions about Candice?

27

EXT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, ATRIUM - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

27

Abiezer and Miguel sit, sipping tea.

ABIEZER

Candice was what they call nosy, you know? Not big on space.

MIGUEL

Don't I know it... In the weeks leading up to her disappearance, did you notice anything off about her behavior?

ABIEZER

Yes. There was one night. About a week before it happened. Candice came here, very late. And she was very on edge. She asked to see the graveyard book.

MIGUEL

The graveyard book?

Mitch walks up with a pile of folders in his arm, slowing at the sight of Miguel.

ABIEZER

Mitchachico here can tell you all about it.

MITCH

About what?

28

INT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, MITCH'S ROOM - DAY

28

Mitch covertly slips the Hell House files into a desk drawer and makes his way to the bookshelf. Standing apart from the cheesy horror novels is a large, leather-bound, ancient BOOK. He grabs it.

Back at his desk, Mitch opens THE GRAVEYARD BOOK and Miguel comes forward, hovering behind him to see. Abiezer, off in the distance, pays them little mind.

MITCH

It's where we keep track of names and personal information. There's also coordinates for location.

MIGUEL

Candice asked to see this?

Mitch nods.

MIGUEL (CONT'D)

Do you know what she did with it?

MITCH

No Sir, I have no idea.

MIGUEL

Could I get a copy of this?

Mitch hands him the original copy.

MITCH
Bring it back whenever.

Miguel takes it, patting Mitch on the shoulder.

MIGUEL
You're still not allowed to see my
step-daughter. Let's keep your name
out of that book, yeah? I've got a
dangerous wife.

Miguel smirks, leaving.

29

INT. LANDRY RESIDENCE, CARRIE'S BEDROOM - DAY

29

Carrie is sitting in front of her mirror, getting ready with
rollers and all.

Lexie exits the bathroom in a robe and towel, wiping her
mouth. She eyes Carrie unseen, then sits beside her.

LEXIE
What are you gonna be for the
Halloween dance?

CARRIE
Carrie.

LEXIE
Iconic.

CARRIE
I know.

Carrie struggles with a hair roller.

CARRIE (CONT'D)
Ugh! Literally what is wrong with
this thing?

Silence. Lexie eyes Carrie.

CARRIE (CONT'D)
Oh my gosh. Lexie, what?

LEXIE
It's nothing.

CARRIE
Then do nothing.

LEXIE

It's just... I noticed you've been pretty soft with Mitch recently.

CARRIE

...What about it?

LEXIE

Nothing. Literally nothing... Just don't forget that he like actually cheated on you with a teacher though.

CARRIE

Is there some reason you're bringing this up? Babe?

LEXIE

No. No reason... I just... I don't want to see him drain you again. It's like so important to hold onto your power, you know?

CARRIE

I do hold onto my power.

LEXIE

Yeah! No. No. Right now? Like you definitely do. I just don't want to see that go away like it did before is all... I found out what his punishment is by the way. For breaking into my house.

CARRIE

What is it?

LEXIE

Community service at the Fall Festival. With Dylan... by the way I'm pretty sure they're official now or something. I, uh... I saw them making out in town yesterday.

Carrie quiets, flawlessly takes out the roller.

CARRIE

That's cute.

Lexie grins. She's got her.

LEXIE

Hey. You know what we should do tonight?

30

INT. SACRED MERCY CHURCH, PORTA POTTY - NIGHT

30

Lexie, Carrie, **DAKOTA GARDENER**, and **MIA BENNETT** huddle in a PORTA POTTY by the festival's pumpkin patch.

CARRIE

Lexie, get your bony elbow out of my freaking boob.

LEXIE

As if it's my fault your boobs take up like half the stall.

CARRIE

This isn't really a time for flattery. Kay?

DAKOTA

Guys, it smells so disgusting. Please. I literally think I might throw up.

Dakota's foot slips and falls into the toilet.

DAKOTA (CONT'D)

(hushed tones)

AH. SHIT. OH FUCK. YOU GUYS. YOU GUYS, MY FOOT FELL IN THE TOILET.

She whines like a youngest sibling.

MIA

Dakota, quiet.

DAKOTA

OK. Seriously, Mia? Carrie and Lexie were literally just like *screaming*.

MIA

No. SH! I think I heard the gates close.

The girls hush. Complete silence. Mia peaks her head out, followed by the rest of the girls.

MIA (CONT'D)

We're clear.

BEGIN MONTAGE:

31

EXT. SACRED MERCY CHURCH, PUMPKIN PATCH - NIGHT

31

- The girl's smash all of the pumpkins, throwing them and kicking them.

- Dakota emerges from another section carrying a massive AX.

DAKOTA

Dudes... look what I just found.

- Carrie axes all the pumpkins. She hits the last one with a particular force, as if to say: and *THAT'S for cheating*.

END MONTAGE.

32

INT. SACRED MERCY CHURCH - DAY

32

A gorgeous Christian church, full of stained glass windows and white light. Wooden panelling. Mitch is thoughtlessly walking through when he spots Dylan.

She's sitting alone, drenched in light. Eyes closed.

The priest rushes in, panicked. It isn't until he addresses both of them that Dylan turns to notice Mitch is there.

PRIEST

Have you guys seen it? It'll take a fortune to replace.

Dylan and Mitch give him a confused look.

33

EXT. SACRED MERCY CHURCH - DAY

33

A field of smashed pumpkins spreads out before Mitch and Dylan. Only one remains. It has a massive KISS MARK on it.

DYLAN

Will you? Replace it?

PRIEST

Of course. It's such a source of joy for the children. I just can't understand how someone could do something like this.

The priest leaves. Dylan looks for Mitch's eyes, but he can't stop averting them.

CARRIE (O.S.)

I JUST GOT THE BEST IDEA.

34

INT. BEAUTY STORE - DAY (FLASHBACK) (CONTINUOUS)

34

Carrie slides onto the floor of a colored hair dye section, Mitch trying to keep up behind her. They're high.

MITCH
How about blue?

CARRIE
How about no way in hell? Here. I like this one.

She kisses her hand.

CARRIE (CONT'D)
Because that's the color.

MITCH
You want my hair to be pink?

CARRIE
I want your hair to be the color of my lips. Is that a problem?

MITCH
No, Ma'am.

He kisses her. She holds up a box of hair dye and slips it into her coat, putting a finger over her lips to shush him.

35

INT. LANDRY RESIDENCE, CARRIE'S BATHROOM - NIGHT (FLASHBACK)

Pink hair dye goops over Mitch's freshly bleached hair. He's wrapped in a pink towel. Carrie sighs, mounts Mitch from the front and continues to massage into his scalp.

CARRIE
Oh, it's gonna look good.

MITCH
Yeah?

CARRIE
Yeah.

Mitch receives a call from VEDA and declines it.

CARRIE (CONT'D)
Who's that?

MITCH
Veda. She's been insane since Chayton left.

CARRIE
She's been insane forever.

Mitch holds his tongue while Carrie thoughtlessly spikes his hair. Quiet... They kiss with passion, but Mitch hesitates.

CARRIE (CONT'D)
What? ...Are you a virgin?

Mitch gives her a guilty look.

CARRIE (CONT'D)
Do you want to be?

36

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, LIBRARY, DESK - DAY

36

Dylan and Mitch sit on a library table with a computer next to them. Two folders are open. They read their own silently, highlighter in hand. Mitch shakes a thought from his head.

DYLAN
I found something.

She starts typing in the computer.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
Bank statements for Michael Hugh.

MITCH
Who's Michael Hugh?

Dylan types his name into a search engine. She sparks up at a series of articles from THE BLACK WILLOW BULLETIN.

DYLAN
Mitch. Mitch. A ton of stuff just
just popped up.

MITCH
Let me see.

He takes control, ignoring Dylan's annoyed reaction.

MITCH (CONT'D)
(reading)
Gunshots heard from within the
Michael Hugh Estate, neighbors on
alert.

He taps Dylan, excited.

MITCH (CONT'D)
We got gunshot reports!

Dylan gives him a horrified look.

MITCH (CONT'D)
(reading)
Black Willow Baron- Oo Baron.
Fancy.

Dylan snatches back the screen.

DYLAN
(reading)
Black Willow baron Michael Hugh
found innocent for murder after
intruder attacks in family estate.

MITCH
Innocent.

They exchange a look.

DYLAN
Dated a year later, "Heiress to the
property typhoon Hugh family goes
missing."

MITCH
Missing?!

DYLAN
And her dad was presumed dead ten
years later.

MITCH
Define presumed.

DYLAN
OK. So our ghost is either Sandra,
Michael, or the intruder he killed.

MITCH
And who was that?

Mitch, with a concerned expression, waits as a printer churns out the image of a young but built black man, his name plastered across the top: **RAYMOND COLE**.

He hears a LAUGH and looks up. It's Carrie, reading "Lolita" to herself in the back of the room. He readies himself to confront her only to be blocked by Parker and his black eye.

PARKER
You checking out my girlfriend,
Bro?

MITCH
Just thinking about how disturbing
her taste in literature is.

Mitch turns to walk away, but Parker calls after him.

PARKER
Yo!

MITCH
I'm sorry. Did you want me to punch
the other eye for a more balanced
look?

Parker steps back with caution.

PARKER
Woah, Bro. We're just talking. All
right? Respect.

Parker holds up his hand for a fist bump. Brows furrowed,
Mitch complies.

PARKER (CONT'D)
You're in that band with my
brother, right?

MITCH
...Yes.

PARKER
Right. And, you know, uh, that's
cool. It's just... Sawyer can be
kind of, like, impersonable. You
know?

MITCH
Impressionable?

PARKER
Yeah, that's what I said. Anyways,
it can be tough, you know, being in
a position like ours?

Mitch looks at him with confusion.

PARKER (CONT'D)
I mean, being the mayor's kids and
all.

Mitch had no idea they were they mayor's kids.

MITCH

Right. Right.

PARKER

Yeah. So shit like, I don't know, painting his nails for example... it just kind of gives the family a bad rep. You know? I mean, look, we're close. He's my brother. And I know he's already got a hard enough time as it is around here without everyone thinking he's... you know...

Mitch looks at him as if he doesn't know, messing with him.

PARKER (CONT'D)

Like...gay.

Mitch pretends to be shocked. Parker nods, serious.

PARKER (CONT'D)

Yeah, right? So maybe like...let's not, yeah? I wouldn't want it to cause a problem for my family and then, you know, me and you. Since we're so tight now. Am I right?

Mitch nods, pretending to consider.

MITCH

No, I totally see what you're saying, Man. I never thought of it that way. It's just kinda funny...

PARKER

What is?

Mitch looks at Carrie. Their eyes lock. He smirks, speaking to Parker without taking his eyes off her.

MITCH

Your girlfriend didn't seem to mind my painted nails when we were dating.

Mitch walks away.

38

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, MS. MARRERO'S CLASS, TABLE - DAY

Dylan is reading articles when Mitch sits next to her with crazed, driven eyes. Exceptionally close.

MITCH

Be my revenge date to the Halloween dance.

Dylan looks around, soft and confused.

DYLAN

...What?

39

EXT. MITCH'S CAR, STREET - NIGHT

39

A black tarp. It's taken off, revealing a pick up truck trunk full of tissue paper rolls.

MITCH (O.S.)

I don't see why you can't just be my revenge date to the Halloween dance.

Dylan, tarp in her hands, looks back to Mitch with a massive smile. Mitch pouts, then starts helping unload the rolls.

DYLAN

I can't go to the Halloween dance. I'm grounded.

MITCH

I don't see why you can't just pretend to be my girlfriend.

DYLAN

You read too much fan fiction.

MITCH

You write too much fan fiction.
Dylanwrites123.

She GASPS, covering her mouth. Mitch smiles. He tosses a roll in his hands.

MITCH (CONT'D)

Oh yeah. This is the good stuff. When it rains tonight? This'll get extra nasty when wet.

DYLAN

That sounds... inappropriate.

MITCH
(bitter)
How appropriate.

Dylan raises her eyebrows.

MITCH (CONT'D)
What's the plan if we're seen?

Dylan smirks.

40 **EXT. LANDRY RESIDENCE - NIGHT**

40

In the center of the street stands two blanket ghosts with holes cut out for eyes: Mitch and Dylan. They have their toilet paper at the ready.

DYLAN
Five... four... three... t-

Mitch CHUCKS his toilet paper. Dylan follows suit.

41 **EXT. PLAYGROUND - NIGHT**

41

High on an energy, Mitch and Dylan topple their way to the neighborhood playground, some leftover toilet paper trailing behind. They're laughing wildly.

42 **EXT. PLAYGROUND - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)**

42

Mitch and Dylan lay on their backs in the fallen leaves. They look over at each other. Neither turns away for a while.

MITCH
I was in love with Carrie... It's
only been two months since we broke
up.

DYLAN
Why did you? Break up, I mean.

MITCH
It's not because of whatever the
hell Lexie was saying. I can tell
you that for sure.

43 **INT. LANDRY RESIDENCE, CARRIE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT (FLASHBACK)**

Mitch, pink haired, wears heart shaped glasses. He looks happier than ever, joking with Carrie and stealing kisses.

MITCH (V.O.)

When we first got together, I kept half expecting her to reveal it was all a prank. Eventually I realized it wasn't though. That, whatever the reason, she actually liked me.

Carrie receives a call from Mia.

MIA (O.S.)

Carrie?!

CARRIE

Hey!

MIA (O.S.)

What are you up to?

Carrie looks at Mitch. She gestures for him to give her a moment.

CARRIE

Nothing. Just home.

Mitch deflates.

MITCH (V.O.)

She was embarrassed about it though.

44

EXT. PLAYGROUND - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

44

Mitch and Dylan are still in their ghost costumes.

DYLAN

How do you know?

Mitch shrugs.

MITCH

Little things...

45

EXT. GARDNER RESIDENCE, BACK YARD- DAY (FLASHBACK)

45

A "pool party" at Dakota's house. The heavy buzz of Summer. Bikinis by the hot tub and no insecurity, it seems.

MITCH (V.O.)

It became really apparent one day at a pool party with all her friends. I overheard about it. Basically begged to go.

46

EXT. GARDNER RESIDENCE, BACK YARD, ANOTHER AREA - DAY
(FLASHBACK)

46

Carrie and Mitch stand side-by-side, looking at the chaos. Carrie turns to Mitch and speaks in an inaudible, seductive whisper.

MITCH (V.O.)
She said *it'd be sexier to keep us*
a secret. I'm literally embarrassed
to have even liked her.

Carrie runs off to greet her friends, leaving Mitch alone.

DYLAN (V.O.)
You shouldn't be embarrassed of how
you feel.

47

EXT. PLAYGROUND - NIGHT

47

Mitch, still in his ghost costume, looks at Dylan. Silence. She comes closer and slowly lifts his sheet, revealing the solemn face below. His eyes swell.

MITCH
I should be... When it might...

Tears break the surface. Mitch weeps. Dylan touches his back.

DYLAN
Might what? Mitch?

Mitch sobs harder. Dylan holds him and he leans into it, eventually simmering to sniffles. He shakes his head.

MITCH
Nothing.

He sighs. He looks at Dylan, biting back a smile.

MITCH (CONT'D)
Take off the costume, Dillstick.

He pulls Dylan's blanket off, messing up her hair.

MITCH (CONT'D)
I like you better alive.

He lays on her lap, using the ghost blankets as a pillow.

MITCH (CONT'D)
(eyes closed)
That means a lot coming from me.

Dylan runs her fingers through Mitch's hair. He opens his eyes slightly, unseen by her, in hope and fear.

MITCH (CONT'D)
...What do you think of Sawyer?

Dylan stops running her fingers through his hair.

DYLAN
Sawyer?

MITCH
Mhm...

DYLAN
Sawyer's brilliant.

Mitch laughs, turning over to look up at her.

MITCH
Brilliant?

DYLAN
Yeah! Don't you think?

MITCH
I mean, he's dope.

DYLAN
Dope?

MITCH
Yeah, he's dope!

Dylan rolls her eyes. Mitch considers his next question.

MITCH (CONT'D)
What is your type anyway? Are you attracted to him at all?

DYLAN
I'm not not attracted to him. Why?

MITCH
He wants to know if you'd go on a date with him. If you'd say yes.

Mitch turns over to capture Dylan's full reaction, grinning.

DYLAN
STOP!

MITCH
Well?

DYLAN

Do you think I should go on a date
with him?

Mitch looks at her and suddenly turns away, facing forward on
her lap. Neither can see the facial expressions of the other.

MITCH

Why does it matter what I think?

DYLAN

...Don't do that.

MITCH

I'd rather you didn't.

DYLAN

Why? ...Mitch?

MITCH

Sh. I'm sleeping.

DYLAN

What's your type? Someone like
Carrie?

MITCH

No.

DYLAN

Then who?

He weighs the risk.

MITCH

You know.

48 **INT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, MITCH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 48

Mitch lays in bed, stuck in the same position. He blushes and
turns over to his other side.

49 **INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 49

Dylan lays in bed on her side, watery eyed and biting her
thumb. THUNDER rolls. She blushes and burrows into herself.

50 **INT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, MITCH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 50

Above the sound of steady RAIN, Mitch receives a TEXT. He
jumps to the phone.

The text is from Dylan: "**extra nasty.**"

He smiles hard, heart light.

51

INT. LANDRY RESIDENCE, CARRIE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

51

Carrie lights candles in a circle surrounding her. She wears her best nightgown.

MR. LANDRY (O.S.)
I BETTER SEE EVERY OUNCE OF TOILET
PAPER CLEANED UP BY TOMORROW NIGHT,
YOUNG LADY.

CARRIE
Keep it up an extra day, Dad.
Halloween's tomorrow. It'll look
cool.

She lights the last candle and looks at her PLUSH PIG,
PORKIE.

CARRIE (CONT'D)
I heard the veil is thinnest
tonight, Porkie.

LIGHTNING STRIKES. She pulls out the tarot deck she bought in
the Summer. Shuffles.

CARRIE (CONT'D)
How does Mitch see me?

The devil card pops out.

CARRIE (CONT'D)
Ha-ha-ha very funny...

Porkie stares, an innocent bystander.

CARRIE (CONT'D)
That can mean like sexy too tough,
right? Ok, whatever, Porkie... Is
there really something happening
between Mitch and Dylan?

The lovers card. Carrie stares at it, frozen, about ready to
cry. She grabs Porkie, clutches him...

CARRIE (CONT'D)
(softly)
What am I even doing?

After a moment, she reaches for the phone on her nightstand.

52 INT. CARRIE'S CAR, BLACK WILLOW ROADS - DAY (FLASHBACK) 52

Carrie checks her phone, following Mitch's location. It leads her to a DRIVEWAY.

CARRIE
What the fuck...

53 EXT. MARRERO RESIDENCE - DAY (FLASHBACK) (CONTINUOUS) 53

Carrie parks, watching with caution as drunk Mitch pounds on an unknown door. To Carrie's horror, **TAMARA MARRERO** emerges. Tears welling up, she watches the teacher console him in discomfoting closeness.

54 INT. CARRIE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT (FLASHBACK) 54

Carrie searches her room for anything Mitch related, throwing it in a box. She hesitates at the copy of Dracula, shoves it in regardless. Carrie closes the box, sealing it in black.

55 INT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, MITCH'S BEDROOM - DAWN (PRESENT DAY)

Sunrise casts an orange light onto the box of Carrie's possessions. A RECORD starts. A Halloween record. Mitch's Halloween socks SLIDE right past the box. He DANCES.

56 INT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, LIVING ROOM - DAWN 56

Abiezer is sleeping on a chair. Mitch brings him Halloween-themed breakfast, kisses his head, and dips out in a rush.

57 EXT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, DRIVEWAY - DAWN 57

Mitch puts on a MONSTER MASK and dances down the street towards Dylan's house.

58 EXT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE - DAWN 58

Mitch, still in his mask, puts a pink-kissed letter "from Carrie" addressed toward Dylan in the Klaypool mailbox.

59 INT. ONYX CAT COFFEE SHOP - DAY (CONTINUOUS) 59

Veda is setting up shop when Mitch trots in, still dancing. He yanks off his mask.

MITCH
HAPPY HALLOWEEN, COUSIN OF
MINE!!!!

He and Veda do their handshake. He pulls out a spooky bag.

MITCH (CONT'D)
Your accessories for tonight.

VEDA
Nothing scarier than consumerism.

MITCH
My thoughts exactly.

Mitch readies to leave.

VEDA
By the way, where do you stand with
Carrie?

MITCH
Loathing, why?

VEDA
That's private information.

MITCH
Fair enough. Oh! I switched the set
up. Wanted to start stronger.

VEDA
What are we starting with?

The SONG starts.

60

INT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, MITCH'S BATHROOM - NIGHT

60

Song still playing. Mitch wears a graphic tee, shakes out his WET HAIR with a TOWEL. Then he removes it, revealing a fresh shade of electric blue. He grins, mouthing the lyrics to his band's Halloween song. He makes a bold performance move...

61

INT. HALLOWEEN DANCE - NIGHT

61

...and finished it on stage. Mitch performs in front of the whole high school, all dressed in costumes. He looks at Sawyer, who seems elated. Everyone loves it.

Everyone loves it except for Carrie. She's sitting down all crossed, looking away from the stage. Parker comes up to her, gesturing to dance. Carrie looks at Mitch, sly.

Carrie steps on the dance floor, dances like a siren. Mitch makes efforts to look away. He's out of it. Sawyer and Veda look at him with faces that say what's up? He falters more. They cover for him, end strong.

MITCH

Much appreciated, thank you!

Carrie looks smug. Veda looks at her like a cat to prey.

MITCH (CONT'D)

I'd like everyone to give a cool
welcome please to none other than
The Walkie Talkie Boys.

Stupid Ball Pit Cult exits the stage as THE WALKIE TALKIE BOYS enter it.

62

INT. HALLOWEEN DANCE, BACK STAGE - NIGHT

62

The Walkie Talkies play a song that muffles behind a curtain. Mitch sits, emotionally and physically exhausted. Veda walks right past him, on a mission. He clocks it, letting her be.

Mitch pulls out his phone, texts Dylan.

SAWYER (O.S.)

AHHH that was incredible.

Mitch looks up as Sawyer approaches. He's beaming.

MITCH

(quietly, looking at his
phone)

Yeah. You killed it. Knew you
would.

Sawyer cocks his head and steals a glance at Mitch's screen.

SAYWER (O.S.)

"I wish you were here." Woah. Uh...
where is Dylan anyway?

MITCH

Grounded.

SAYWER

I see. Did you, uh, did you get a
chance to ask. You know, about me?

MITCH

I did.

SAWYER

And?

MITCH

She called you brilliant and not
unattractive.

SAWYER

Oh. Ok. Ok. Yeah?

MITCH

Yeah, man. I just, uh...

A STAGE HAND rushes in, whispering into Mitch's ear.

MITCH (CONT'D)

(to Sawyer)

One sec.

Mitch goes with the stage hand. Sawyer nods, left alone.

63

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, HALLWAY - NIGHT

63

Sawyer, hands in his pockets, walks through an empty hallway. Lights flicker. He reaches into his coat pocket, drinks from a flask.

He hears a noise: someone hyperventilating. On the ground, he finds a CLASSIC WITCH'S HAT. He looks around, walks forward.

At the end of the hallway, Sawyer sees a girl pacing in a gorgeous, gothic, black ballgown below a cape.

SAWYER

H- hello?

The girl turns around. It's Dylan. She looks beautiful.

SAWYER (CONT'D)

You dropped this. Wouldn't be much
of a witch without it, would you?

DYLAN

No, I wouldn't. Thank you, Sawyer.

Dylan takes the hat, holds it at her side.

SAWYER

I thought you were grounded.

Dylan shrugs, distracted.

SAWYER (CONT'D)
You're missing the party.

DYLAN
I can't go in there like this.

SAWYER
Why not?

DYLAN
Isn't it too much?

SAWYER
...Only if you want to be
forgotten.

Dylan thinks. She tilts her head down, puts on the hat...

64

INT. HALLOWEEN DANCE - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

64

...she takes off her cape, letting it float down.

Mitch crouches with his back to the front door, hovering over the fog machine. He gives it a final screw.

MITCH
(to the stagehand)
Ha! I got it!

He follows the line of fog as it spreads across the room and climbs all the way up to Dylan's draping gown.

Ever so slowly, Dylan reveals her face from below the hat. Everyone is in awe, but the most in awe is Mitch. It's more than her looking pretty. It feels... powerful. Harmonious.

Then, a CONFETTI CANNON goes off and a thousand black hearts spew out of it. LAUGHS are soon met by somber whispers. Mitch picks up a heart, reading the text on it.

MITCH (CONT'D)
"Kill yourself, Carrie Landry."

Everyone's attention shifts to Carrie, a circle of students forming around her. Mitch looks back and forth between her and Dylan. And he goes to Carrie.

MITCH (CONT'D)
Are you OK?

CARRIE
Fine...

She's about to cry. The crowd parts as they walk through it.

65

EXT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY - NIGHT

65

Moonlight casts a cold glow over the cobblestone steps.
Carrie sits beside Mitch.

CARRIE

For a second, I thought you did it.

MITCH

My guess is Veda.

CARRIE

Ugh. She's such a freak. Why are
you two even friends?

MITCH

Our parents were cousins. We're
second cousins.

CARRIE

So?

MITCH

She's family. We grew up together.
She defends me-

CARRIE

I'm sorry, defends you? From
fucking what? Was I not the one you
cheated on? Now you think I deserve
death threats?

MITCH

No I don't think that. That would
make me a terrible person and I
seriously have to reconsider my
relationship with her now. But for
the last time, I did not cheat on
you.

CARRIE

I saw it.

MITCH

What?

CARRIE

I followed you after the party. I
saw you two together.

MITCH

That's because Ms. Marrero is my aunt.

Carrie pauses, then LAUGHS.

CARRIE

Hey. What's a guy to do when he's related to every woman town?

Mitch looks at her. *That was way out of line and not OK.*

MITCH

Are you accusing me of incest?

Carrie makes a face: *uh duh.*

MITCH (CONT'D)

And my aunt, the only mother figure left in my life? Who could lose everything if that rumor got out?

CARRIE

Maybe she got the taste for fucking family *from* your mom. Hm? Why else would you be so obsessed with ghosts?

Mitch stares at her, incredulous.

MITCH (V.O.)

And that, ladies and gentlemen, was the moment of my exorcism.

66 **INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, HALLWAY - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)** 66

Mitch runs through Black Willow Academy, decided on Dylan.

67 **INT. HALLOWEEN DANCE - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)** 67

Mitch bursts through the Halloween Dance doors.

MITCH

Dylan?!

She's not there.

68 **INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, ANOTHER HALLWAY - NIGHT** 68

A cluster of STUDENTS stands in his path, chatting casually. Mitch barrels through them, shoving a boy aside.

MITCH
Pardon me! Dylan!

He runs, desperation mounting, and notices Ms. Marrero's classroom door ajar. He slows.

69

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, MS. MARRERO'S CLASSROOM - NIGHT

Mitch, out of breath, opens Ms. Marrero's classroom door. Dylan is there. Slow dancing in Sawyer's arms.

END OF EPISODE